irregular words. When using class names composed of two or more words, the model class name should follow the Ruby conventions, using the CamelCase form, while the table name must contain the words separated by underscores. Examples:

- Database Table - Plural with underscores separating words (e.g., `book_clubs`).
- Model Class - Singular with the first letter of each word capitalized (e.g., `BookClub`).

Model / Class	Table / Schema
`Article`	`articles`
`LineItem`	`line_items`
`Deer`	`deers`
`Mouse`	`mice`
`Person`	`people`

2.2 Schema Conventions

Active Record uses naming conventions for the columns in database tables, depending on the purpose of these columns.

- **Foreign keys** - These fields should be named following the pattern `singularized_table_name_id` (e.g., `item_id`, `order_id`). These are the fields that Active Record will look for when you create associations between your models.
- **Primary keys** - By default, Active Record will use an integer column named `id` as the table's primary key. When using Active Record Migrations to create your tables, this column will be automatically created.

There are also some optional column names that will add additional features to Active Record instances:

- `created_at` - Automatically gets set to the current date and time when the record is first created.
- `updated_at` - Automatically gets set to the current date and time whenever the record is updated.
- `lock_version` - Adds optimistic locking to a model.
- `type` - Specifies that the model uses Single Table Inheritance.
- `(association_name)_type` - Stores the type for polymorphic associations.
- `(table_name)_count` - Used to cache the number of belonging objects on associations. For example, a `comments_count` column in a `Articles` class that has many instances of `Comment` will cache the number of existent comments for each article.

While these column names are optional, they are in fact reserved by Active Record. Steer clear of reserved keywords unless you want the extra functionality. For example, `type` is a reserved keyword used to designate a table using Single Table Inheritance (STI). If you are not using STI, try an analogous keyword like "context", that may still accurately describe the data you are modeling.

3 Creating Active Record Models

It is very easy to create Active Record models. All you have to do is to subclass the `ActiveRecord::Base` class and you're good to go:

```
class Product < ActiveRecord::Base
end
```